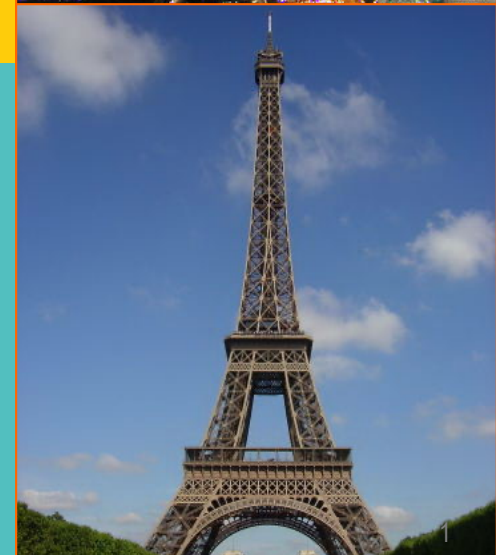


Epita Cross-Border Management Class

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Cross-Border Management

Second Class

Reminder - My expectations Towards You 1/2

At the beginning of each class you are responsible for:

1



2



3



4



Reminder - My Expectations Towards You 2/2

For each class you are responsible for:

1

Having homework ready
/ sent to me by the
deadline



2

Speaking up in class!



3

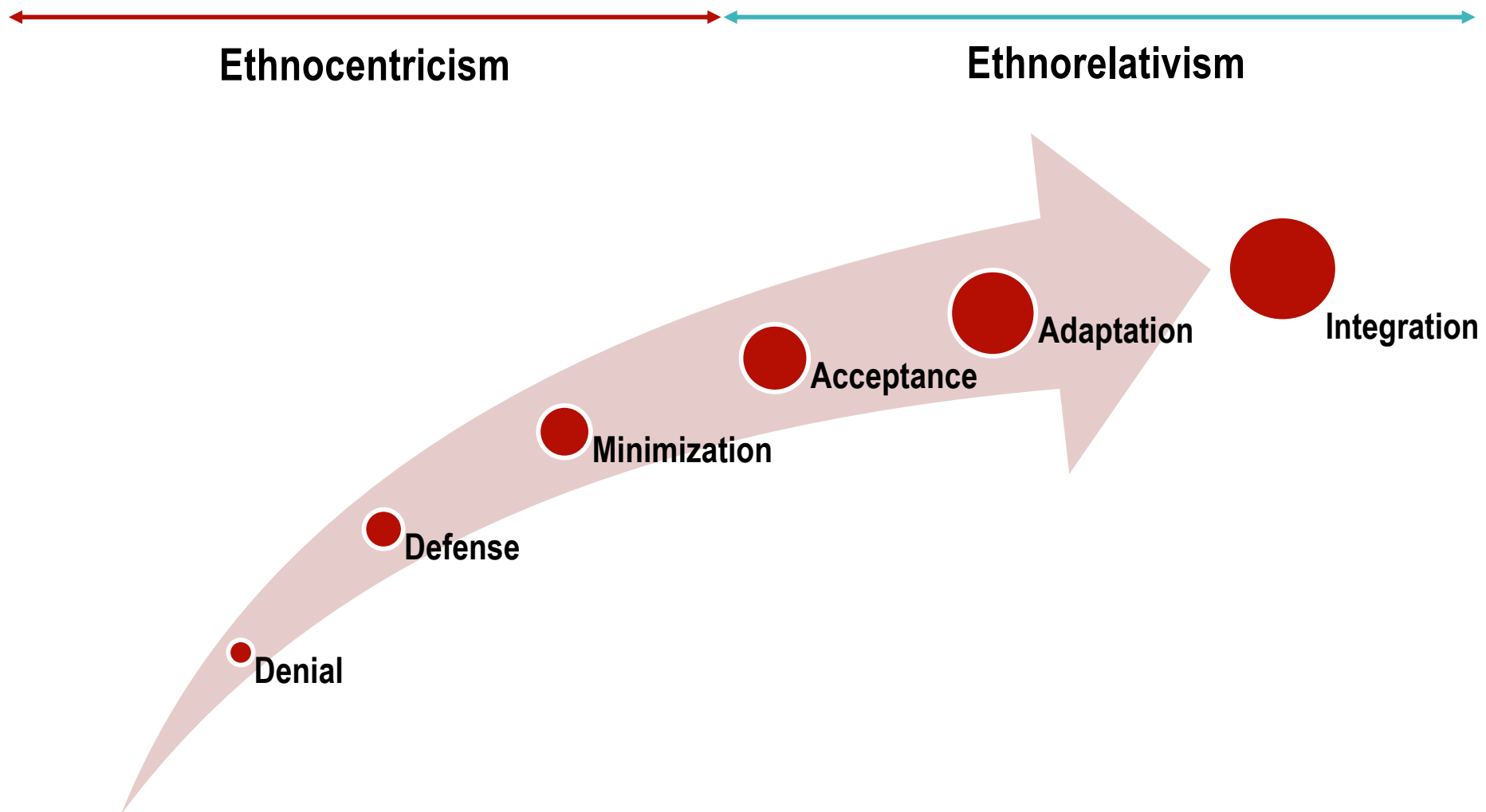


Homework for Class #2

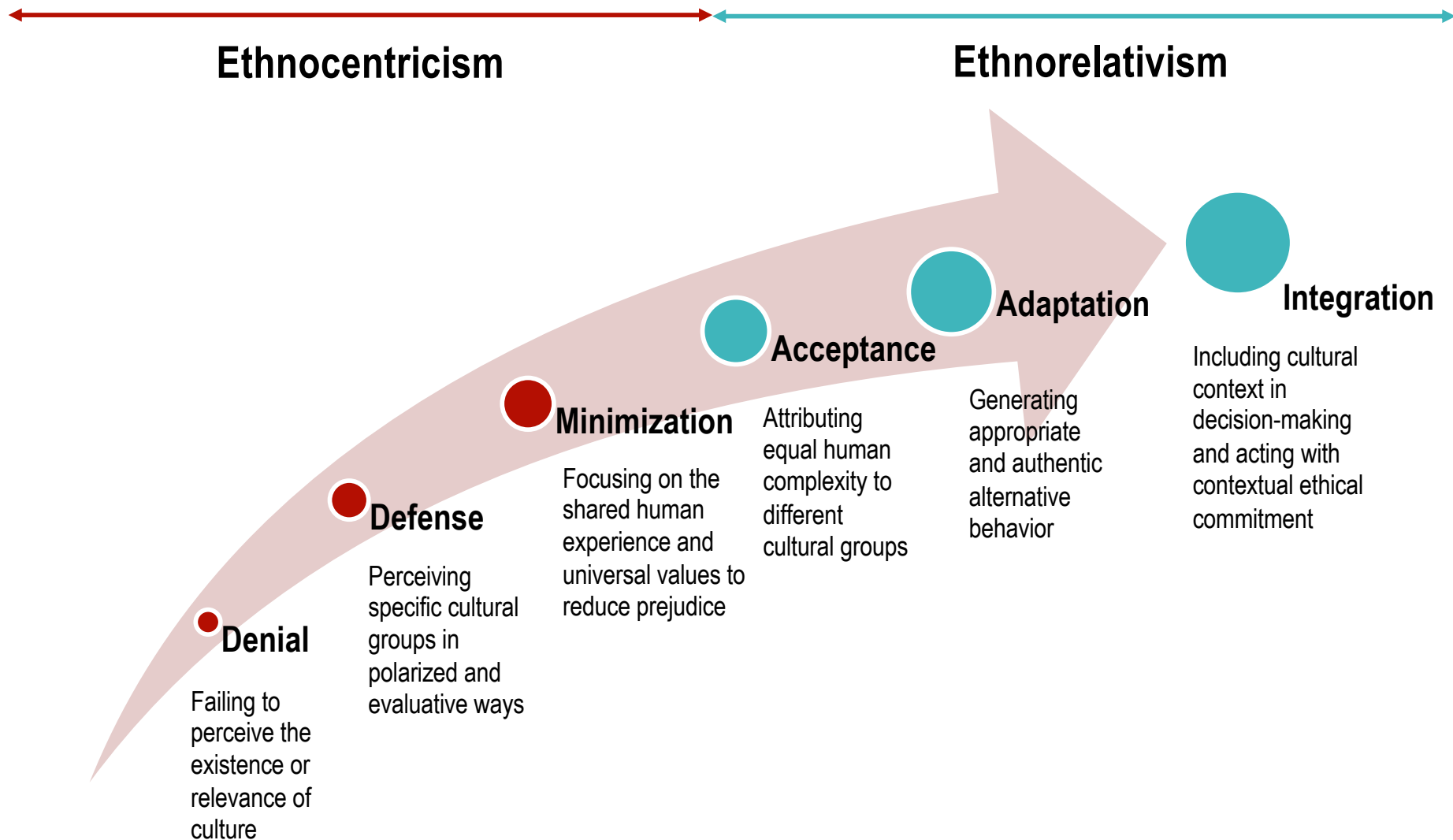
Be ready with your answers for class #2
No need to send me anything in advance

- ⌘ Go online and complete your COF cultural profile on <https://www.cofassessment.com/>
 - Edit your profile (COF report) and have a copy during classes #2 and #3 (see next slide)
- ⌘ Watch the enclosed video on ethnocentrism:
 - <https://www.khanacademy.org/test-prep/mcat/individuals-and-society/perception-prejudice-and-bias/v/ethnocentrism-and-cultural-relativism-in-group-and-out-group>
- ⌘ Think of personal experiences related to your home country or any other country with which you have experience.
 - Prepare one example per dimension (i.e. independent-interdependent, egalitarian-status, risk-certainty) so **3 examples** in total **that illustrate each dimension** (Please get ready to tell us which side of the dimension)..

Developmental Model of Intercultural Sensitivity (Milton Bennett)



Developmental Model of Intercultural Sensitivity (Milton Bennett)



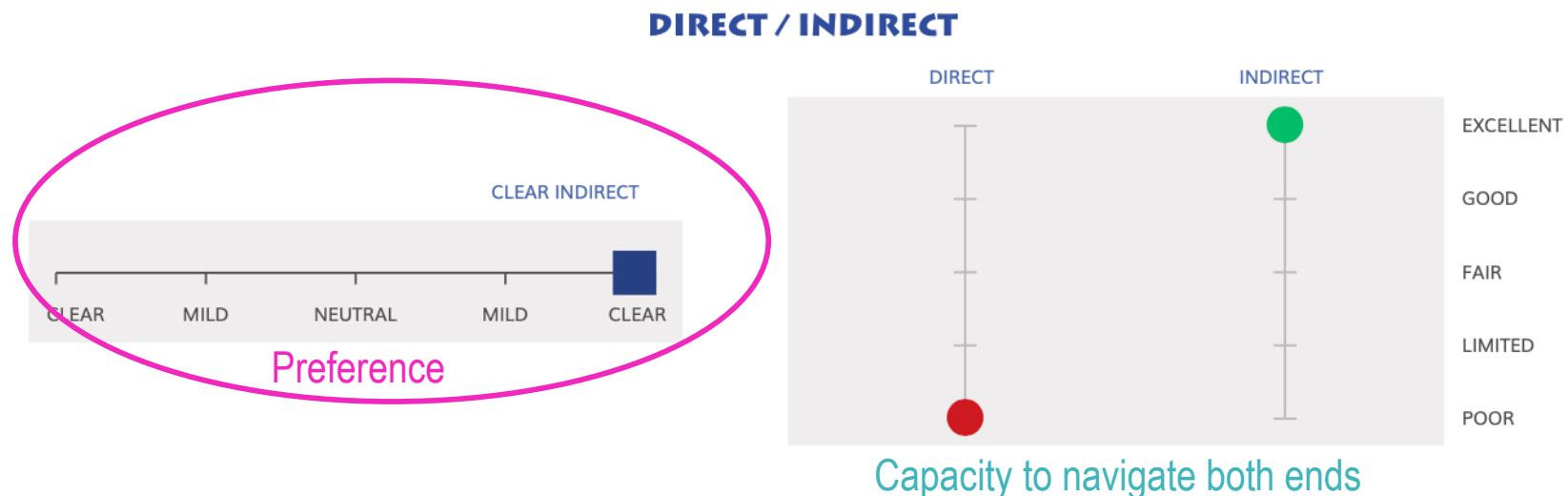
Example of a C.O.F. report



Example of the cover page of the report of your own cultural profile obtained from the COF website once you have answered all the questions.

How to Understand your COF Profiles?

- ✂ On your profile as shown on your COF report, you see two charts.
- ✂ On the left it shows your **preference** on a five-point scale.
 - In the example below, the person has a strong preference for indirectness.
- ✂ On the right, it shows your **capacity** to use each end of a dimension.
 - In the example below, the person displays **full capacity to be indirect**, however has very **limited capacity to be direct** if need be.



Comparing GlobeSmart and COF Models

- ❖ For class #3, please focus only on GlobeSmart's five dimensions and on your COF **preferences only (horizontal bar)**
- ❖ Correspondance in terms of vocabulary:
 - Independent-Interdependent (GS) -> **Individualist-Collectivist** (COF – p5)
 - Egalitarian-Status (GS) -> **Hierarchy-Equality*** (COF – p6)
 - Risk-Certainty (GS) -> **Stability-Change*** (COF – p6)
 - Direct-Indirect (GS) -> **Direct-Indirect** (COF – p8)
 - Task-Relationship (GS) -> **Being-Doing*** (COF – p5)

GLOBESMART®



COF™

*** Beware! This dimension is presented in a direction OPPOSITE to that of GlobeSmart.**

Direct-Indirect

How do I communicate tasks, requests, and feedback?



- ❖ Concise, concrete, to the point
- ❖ Not afraid to say 'it is like it is'.
- ❖ Difficulties confronted openly
- ❖ OK to give and receive 'constructive' feedback.



- ❖ Great attention given to how messages are expressed
- ❖ Preserve harmony in group
- ❖ Pay attention to saving face and preserving personal dignity
- ❖ Unwillingness to say no

Say it in the Opposite Style!

Direct communication

- ✘ 'We cannot do this.'
- ✘ ...
- ✘ ...
- ✘ 'This cannot be done today.'
- ✘ Direct communicators think: '...'
- ✘ 'Yes' means 'I agree'.
- ✘ 'We will consider it' signals...
- ✘ 'No' indicates rejection.

Indirect communication

- ✘ ...
- ✘ 'We need time to think about it.'
- ✘ 'This is an interesting perspective.'
- ✘ ...
- ✘ Indirect communicators think they must be respectful of others.
- ✘ 'Yes' means ...
- ✘ 'We will consider it' signals skepticism or rejection.
- ✘

Say it in the Opposite Style! – Possible Answers

Direct communication

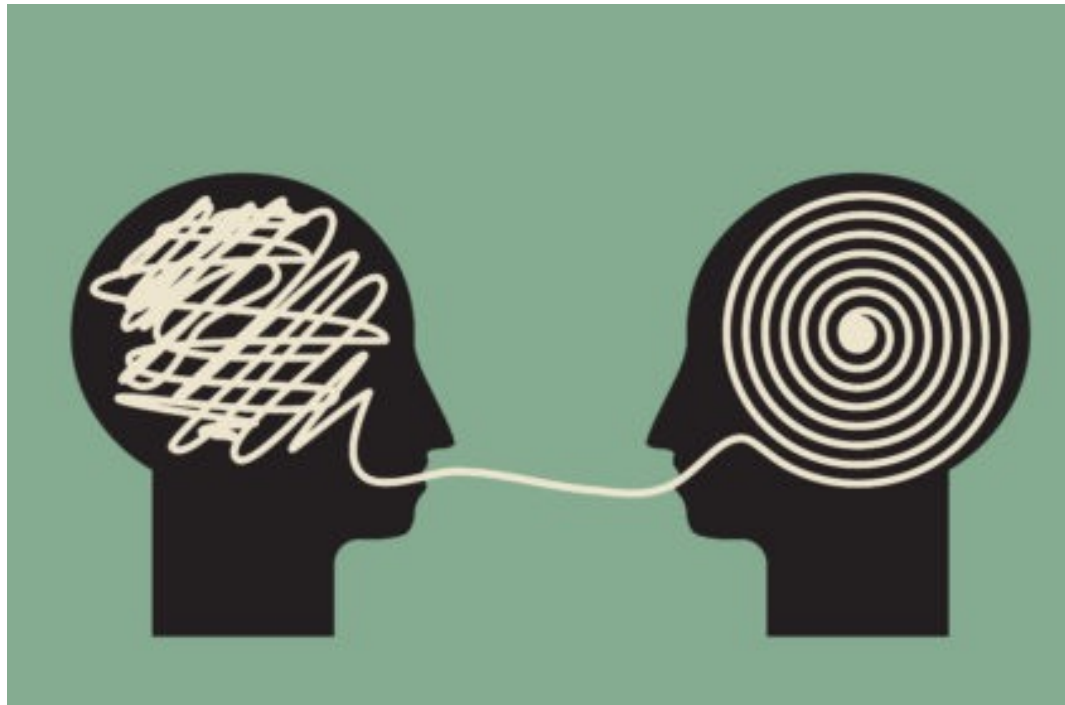
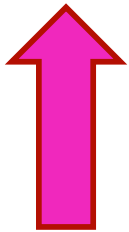
- ⌘ 'We cannot do this.'
- ⌘ 'Your proposal is unacceptable.'
- ⌘ 'This is not correct.'
- ⌘ 'This cannot be done today.'
- ⌘ 'I'm just calling things what they are.'
- ⌘ 'Yes', means 'I agree'.
- ⌘ 'We will consider it' signals interest.
- ⌘ 'No' indicates rejection.

Indirect communication

- ⌘ 'This may be difficult.'
- ⌘ 'We need time to think about it.'
- ⌘ 'This is an interesting perspective.'
- ⌘ 'We will see.'
- ⌘ We must be respectful of others.
- ⌘ 'Yes' means 'I heard what you said.'
- ⌘ 'We will consider it' signals skepticism or rejection.
- ⌘ 'No' is rarely used.

The Art of Translation

Upgraders



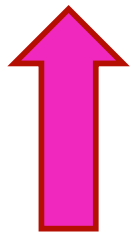
Downgraders



Upgraders and Downgraders

Upgraders intensify messages.

- More likely to show up in more direct cultures
- Examples: "Absolutely", "completely", "terribly" etc.



Downgraders / upgraders are especially used when expressing disagreement or criticism.



Downgraders soften up messages.

- More likely to show up in more indirect cultures.
- "a little", "maybe", "slightly" etc.

France - Deciphering a French 'no' from A 'yes'

Rather 'no'

- Really?
- Je voudrais mettre un bémol*
- Do you really think that...?
- It could be maybe better if
- Your remark needs to be qualified a bit
- I am not sure this idea is basically the best one
- I am not fully convinced that
- I'm afraid it could be difficult
- Honestly (à vrai dire)
- Yes, but...

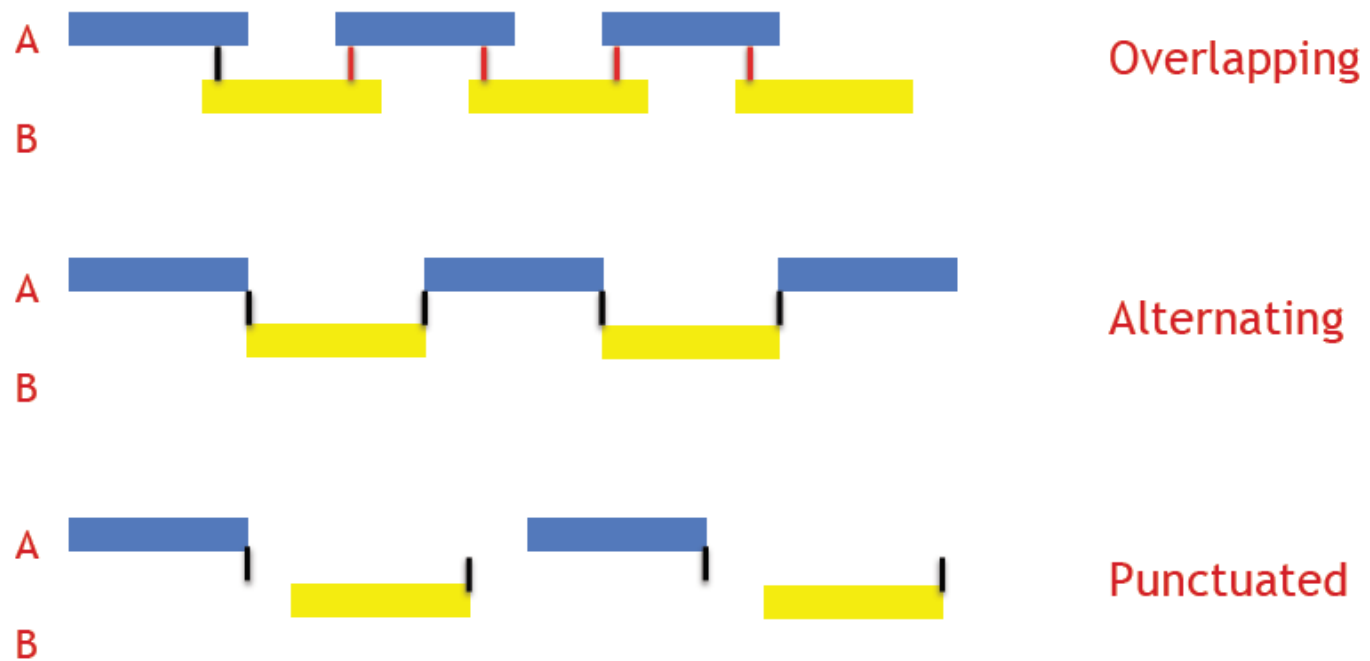
'Yes', 'no' or neutral

(depending on the context or the intonation)

- One can see things this way.
- Why not?
- It's an idea.
- It's possible.
- It remains to be seen (c'est à voir)

* I'd like to be more cautious / I need to put a damper on...

Conversation Styles



**What is the first thing you do when
you arrive to the office in the
morning?**



18

Task-Relationship

When working on projects, do I prefer to address tasks or relationship first?

Task



- ❖ Place high value on reaching goals and objectives on schedule
- ❖ Prioritize accomplishing tasks over maintaining relationships
- ❖ Focus on what people achieve more than who they know

Relationship



- ❖ View time building relationships as key to achieving good results
- ❖ Prioritize maintaining relationships over accomplishing tasks on time
- ❖ Focus on who people know as much as what they themselves can achieve

How to Deal in Action with Different Profiles?

Trompenaar's 4 R method

1 Recognize

Identify and understand different cultural (national, organizational, functional etc.) perspectives, attitudes and behaviors and their implications in co-operation, leadership and management.

2 Respect

Build appreciation and respect for the cultural differences in values, styles, viewpoints and approaches, without recourse to destructive stereotyping.

3 Reconcile

Reconcile the dilemmas that result from the tensions between different viewpoints by integrating the different value orientations. This allows to benefit from differences and reach win-win solutions.

4 Realize

Implement the reconciliations and embed across the organization a mindset that continually reconciles dilemmas, to fully realize the business benefits.

Situation 1

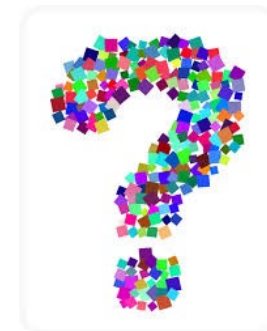
- ❖ An American company specializing in e-commerce wants to publish a new updated version of the website. Lots of bugs are still unsolved. The manager (boss) of a virtual team is an American based in the US; his team is made up of 10 employees dispersed on three continents. The French team member (a manager) is concerned about users' complaints. To him quality is the utmost priority. The reactions of the other team members are mixed, and he cannot use them as arguments to sustain his position.
- ❖ As the next team meeting is due only in two weeks but the update is to happen shortly, many emails are exchanged back and forth. Finally the US boss and his team member in France have a heated conversation and at 8.00 pm French time a decision is made ending the discussion.

❖ **What dimension(s) is/are at play in this situation?**



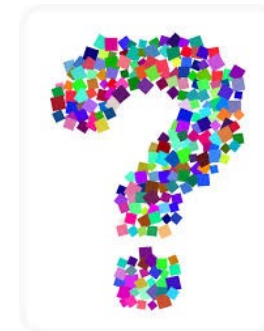
Situation 2

- ❖ Pierre is a French citizen on a business trip to China for 10 days. Since he studied there for a while and worked for two years in a Franco-Chinese Joint-Venture before returning home, he knows quite a few people in Shanghai. He is now employed in another company in Paris. He is particularly eager to see his Chinese friends since he rarely has this privilege.
- ❖ He has been traveling around a lot during the first week of his trip and is tired when he finally returns to Shanghai. He feels he needs to rest, spend a bit of time alone in his hotel room and 'walk off the pressure' before seeing his friends. But his friends keep on calling him on his cell phone to arrange a meeting.
- ❖ He explains that he needs to spend a bit of time alone first and that he will call them back as soon as possible.
- ❖ **What dimension(s) is/are at play in this situation?**



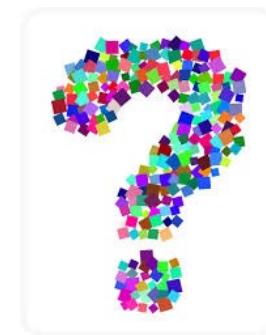
Situation 3

- ⌘ An American company with subsidiaries on four continents is streamlining its HR policy. For annual employee evaluations, one unique document is available to all the subsidiaries providing the same questions. The manager will evaluate the employee during an annual interview session. The evaluation sheet is then centralized and accessible by HR, both centrally and locally. The ultimate objective is to be able to compare employees of the same level of qualifications and competences all over the world.
- ⌘ In the Argentina operations, one employee is considered highly competent by both his direct line report and the local head. They both agree he needs to be promoted. Instead of evaluating the person on the pre-defined criteria during an interview, the two managers filled out the sheet so as to match the central HR expectations and make sure their protégé will be eligible for promotion.
- ⌘ **What dimension(s) is/are at play in this situation?**



Situation 4

- ❖ Martine Moreau is an experienced French accountant based in Paris, France. She works for an international company. Her boss is German and based in Munich.
- ❖ One day, she sends out documents to him. He sends a short email back as follows: 'Your calculations are incorrect. Please check your document and resend it to me by tomorrow'.
- ❖ She was so upset by such rudeness that she did not reply. The German manager was equally shocked by the lack of responsiveness and professionalism of his team member.
- ❖ **What dimension(s) is/are at play in this situation?**
- ❖ **What should have the German boss said and done to obtain a positive feedback from Martine Moreau?**



Homework for Class #3

- Think of personal experiences related to your home country / France / any other country with which you have a lot of experience.
 - Prepare **one example per dimension** (direct to indirect, and task to relationship) so 2 examples in total that illustrate each dimension.
- ⌘ Prepare and reflect on the following three questions:
 - What are the needs/drive of an indirect person? And of a direct one?
 - What are the needs/drive of a risk-oriented person? And of a certainty one?
 - What are the needs/drive of a task-oriented person?
 - What are differences btw. someone who is relationship-oriented and s.o. who is interdependent?
- ⌘ Prepare **one core value** of your country of origin and be ready to explain how it plays out.
- ⌘ Bring your COF profile to class #3
- ⌘ Watch the enclosed video on high/low context: www.youtube.com/watch?v=9oYfhTC9IIQ
 - What is the difference between high context and indirect on one hand and low context and direct on the other hand?

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The Nations of the World



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Robinson Projection



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